

Low-fidelity Prototyping

- Uses a medium which is unlike the final medium, e.g. paper, cardboard
- Is quick, cheap and easily changed
- Examples:
 - sketches of screens, task sequences, etc
 - ‘post-it’ notes
 - storyboards
 - ‘Wizard-of-Oz’

Storyboards

- Often used with scenarios, bringing more detail, and a chance to role play
- It is a series of sketches showing how a user might progress through a task using the device
- Used early in design

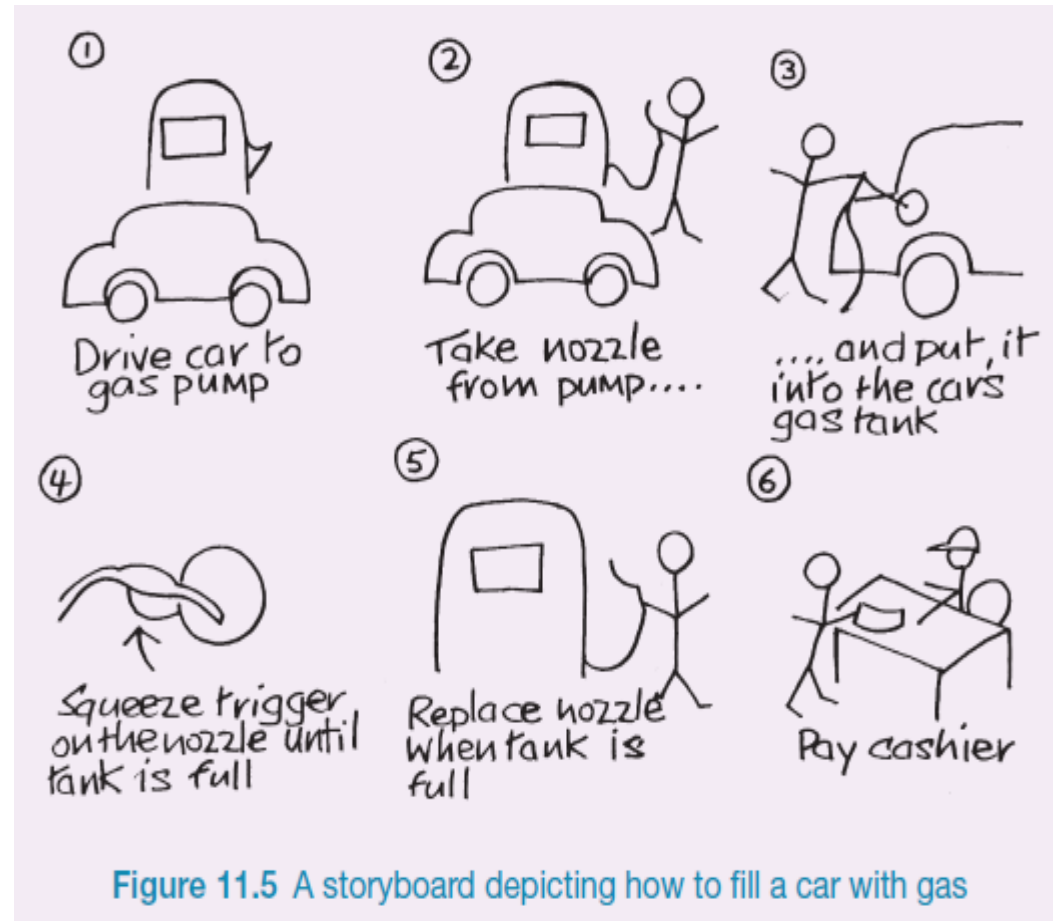
Example storyboard

Type	Advantages	Disadvantages
Low-fidelity prototype	Lower development cost Evaluates multiple design concepts Useful communication device Addresses screen layout issues Useful for identifying market requirements Proof of concept	Limited error checking Poor detailed specification to code to Facilitator-driven Limited utility after requirements established Limited usefulness for usability tests Navigational and flow limitations
High-fidelity prototype	Complete functionality Fully interactive User-driven Clearly defines navigational scheme Use for exploration and test Look and feel of final product Serves as a living specification Marketing and sales tool	More resource-intensive to develop Time-consuming to create Inefficient for proof-of-concept designs Not effective for requirements gathering

Table 11.3 Advantages and disadvantages of low- and high-fidelity prototypes

Sketching

- Sketching is important to low-fidelity prototyping
- Don't be inhibited about drawing ability. Practice simple symbols



Card-based prototypes

Travel Organizer 23 August

WELCOME HELEN

Where do you want to go? YORK

What date do you want to travel? 16 Sept

Which form of transport do you want? TRAIN

Do you need accommodation? YES

Travel Organizer 23 August

Train timetable from Milton Keynes Central to York on 16 Sept

Depart	09:09	10:09	same	22:09
Arrive	12:30	13:30	mins past hour	01:30

Accommodation

Hotel	B & B
£40 to £150	£20 to £60

- Index cards (3 X 5 inches)
- Each card represents one screen or part of screen
- Often used in website development

‘Wizard-of-Oz’ prototyping

- The user thinks they are interacting with a computer, but a developer is responding to output rather than the system.
- Usually done early in design to understand users’ expectations
- What is ‘wrong’ with this approach?

